



PARAM PRASAD CHARITABLE SOCIETY'S
SAINT JOSEPH'S SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL

Together in Pursuing Excellence

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ATLANTIC OCEAN

Geography and Features:

The Atlantic Ocean is a vast body of water, covering approximately 20% of the Earth's surface. It stretches from the Arctic Ocean in the north to the Southern Ocean in the south, separating the Americas from Europe and Africa. The Atlantic is the second-largest ocean, with an average depth of around 3,332 meters (10,932 feet). The Mid-Atlantic Ridge, a mountain range, runs down the center of the Atlantic, part of the global mid-ocean ridge system. The Puerto Rico Trench is the deepest point, reaching 8,376 meters (27,480 feet).

Climate and Currents:

The Atlantic Ocean plays a significant role in regulating global climate patterns. The Gulf Stream, a warm ocean current, originates in the Gulf of Mexico and influences Western Europe's climate, keeping temperatures relatively mild. In contrast, the Labrador Current and Falkland Current bring cold waters from the Arctic and Antarctic. The North Atlantic is known for intense storms and rough seas, making it a challenging region for shipping and navigation.

Marine Life:

The Atlantic Ocean supports a vast array of marine life, with diverse ecosystems including coral reefs, kelp forests, and deep-sea trenches. Many species migrate through the Atlantic, including humpback whales, orcas, and sea turtles. Loggerhead and leatherback turtles' nest on Atlantic beaches, while cod, herring, and other fish are harvested in the ocean's fishing grounds. The Sargasso Sea, a region in the North Atlantic, is known for its unique seaweed ecosystems.

Human Impact:

The Atlantic Ocean is a vital part of global trade, with many ships crossing daily. The ocean's fishing grounds are also an important source of food, with cod, herring, and other fish being harvested. However, human activities have taken a toll on the Atlantic's ecosystems. Plastic waste, oil spills, and overfishing threaten marine life, while climate change affects ocean currents and temperatures. Efforts are being made to mitigate these impacts and protect the Atlantic's marine biodiversity.

Geography:

Location: Separates the Americas from Europe and Africa

Size: Approximately 106 million square miles (274 million square kilometres), covering about 20% of the Earth's water surface

Depth: Average depth is around 3,332 meters (10,932 feet), with the Puerto Rico Trench reaching 8,376 meters (27,480 feet)

Length: Stretches from the Arctic Ocean in the north to the Southern Ocean in the south

Interesting Features

Mid-Atlantic Ridge: The Mid-Atlantic Ridge is a mountain range that runs down the centre of the Atlantic and forms part of the global mid-ocean ridge system.

Sargasso Sea: A region in the North Atlantic with unique seaweed ecosystems

Gulf Stream: A warm ocean current originating in the Gulf of Mexico, influencing Western Europe's climate

Bermuda Triangle: A region in the North Atlantic known for mysterious disappearances of ships and planes.

North Atlantic Oscillation (NAO): A climate pattern affecting weather in Europe and North America

Bordering Countries

Europe: UK, France, Spain, Portugal, and others

Africa: Morocco, Western Sahara, Mauritania, and others

Americas: United States, Canada, Brazil, Argentina, and others

Economic Importance

Shipping: Key trade routes, including the North Atlantic Route

Fishing: Major fishing grounds, including cod and herring

Oil and Gas: Significant offshore reserves, particularly in the North Sea and Gulf of Mexico

Tourism: Popular destinations like the Caribbean islands and Mediterranean coast

Marine Life

Diverse ecosystems: Coral reefs, kelp forests, and deep-sea trenches

Species: Over 100,000 estimated marine species, including whales, dolphins, sea turtles, and sharks

Migration routes: Many species migrate through the Atlantic, including humpback whales and sea turtles

Environmental Concerns

Pollution: Plastic waste, oil spills, and chemical runoff

Overfishing: Depletion of fish stocks and damage to marine ecosystems

Climate Change: Rising sea temperatures, ocean acidification, and sea-level rise

History and Exploration

Early exploration: Vikings, Portuguese, and Spanish explorers

Transatlantic slave trade: Millions of enslaved Africans transported to the Americas

World War II: Important naval battles and convoys

The Atlantic Ocean plays a vital role in global trade, climate regulation, and marine biodiversity.

